



2016 考研五一集训营

考研英语基础写作讲义

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一、大作文

I. 考试大纲以及评分标准介绍

A. 评分标准

得分		内容切题	思想表达	连贯性	语言错误	句型	用词
A 节	B 节						
0	0	白卷或文不对题	孤立词无法理解	^*#%... @\$&%¥	绝非人类语言		
1~2	1~4	基本涉及题目内容	少数句子可以理解	条理不清	语言支离破碎		
3~4	5~8	基本切题	表达思想不清楚	连贯性差	较多严重错误	略显句型意识	较多用词错误
5~6	9~12	切题	局部表达不够清楚	基本连贯	少量严重错误	体现句型意识	较少用词错误
7~8	13~16	切题	表达思想清楚	连贯	没有严重错误	凸现句型意识	用词没有重大错误
9~10	17~20	切题	表达思想清楚	文章通顺连贯性好	基本无误	句型富于变化	用词无误

B. 考试命题要求

短文作文考试主要有以下几种：

以史为鉴

考试年份	考试题目	话题范围
2001	爱心是一盏明灯	青年思想
2002	穿中国服饰的外国女孩	社会现象
2003	温室的花朵	青年思想
2004	终点就是起点	青年思想
2005	养老足球赛	社会现象
2006	小贝头	社会现象
2007	大球门与小球门	青年思想
2008	瘸子一起跑步	青年思想
2009	网络的远与近	社会现象
2010	文化火锅	社会现象
2011	旅途之余	社会现象
2012	积极心态看人生	青年思想
2013	大学生毕业选择	社会现象
2014	赡养老人	青年思想
2015	手机时代的聚会	社会现象

II. 短文写作基本常识

A. 段落

1. 段落的组织结构

a. 主题句

i. 主题句放置

In general, a sensible plan is to tell readers what the paragraph is intended to discuss before it is discussed. Thus, the common practice in writing a paragraph is to begin with the topic sentence and to follow it with supporting sentences. Wherever the topic sentence is placed, it serves the special purpose of announcing the paragraph's topic.

a. To be successful in a job interview, the applicant should demonstrate certain personal and professional qualities. For example, the job applicant should take care to appear well-groomed and modestly dressed, avoiding the extremes of too elaborate or

too casual clothes. Besides care for personal appearance, he should pay close attention to his manner of speaking, which should be neither ostentatious nor familiar but straightforward and friendly. In addition, he should have the knowledge, skills and work experiences as required for the position. And finally, the really impressive applicant must convey a sense of self-confidence and enthusiasm for work, which all interviewers value highly. The job seeker who displays these characteristics, with just a little luck, will certainly succeed in the typical personnel interview.

b. He had the emotional stability of a six-year-old child. When he felt out of sorts, he would rave and stamp, or sink into suicidal gloom and talk darkly of going to the East to end his days as a monk. Then minutes later, when something pleased him, he would rush out of doors and run around the garden, or jump up and down on the sofa, or stand on his head. He could be grief-stricken over the death of a pet dog, and he could be callous and heartless to a degree that would have made a Roman emperor shudder.

c. The sky is clear blue. Sparrows chirp in the early morning. The fruit trees in the backyard are beginning to bloom. The hills are turning green, and purple and yellow wildflowers are appearing in the fields. The snow on top of Camel Mountain has all melted. It must finally be spring.

ii. Three characteristics of well-written topic sentences

1. It includes a topic and a controlling idea.

e. g.: Hong Kong is a fascinating mixture of Europe and Asiatic traditions.

e. g.: Collaborating with Einstein was an unforgettable experience.

e. g.: The year 1884-1885 was a period of great adventure for me.

e. g.: Television programs for children have become increasingly violent.

e. g.: Learning a foreign language is more and more important for young people.

2. It should be of the “right size”—neither too broad to support it adequately, nor so narrow that it does not require any support.

e. g.: My hometown is famous for several amazing geographical features. First, it is noted for the Yangtze River, which is very wide and beautiful. Also, on the other side of the town is Baiyan Hill, which is unusual because it is very steep.

e. g.: The spelling of the word centre in British English is different from that in American English.

3. It should also indicate a possible way of development.

Exercise I: Study the following topics and try to formulate a topic sentence that has a controlling idea.

A. The Online Chat Rooms

D. College education

B. Job Interview

E. Ambition

C. Cooperation

F. Urban Expansion

1. _____ is known as one of the most serious problems in today's society. We can see it almost everywhere. As the graph depicts, _____.

2. From the cartoon, we can see that it's a forceful satire on the kind of _____.

3. From the first graph, we learn that _____. According to the statistics shown in the second graph, we can see that _____.

4. This table shown us that _____. The figures indicate that there is an inspiring tendency of _____.

5. What you first think of when seeing this cartoon might be that _____. As a matter of fact, this cartoon reveals a typical social phenomenon.

6. According to the first graph, it can be seen that _____, it can also be concluded from it that _____.

7. There is an interesting and instructive picture which goes like this: _____.

8. Nowadays there is a growing concern over _____. Many people like _____, while others are inclined to _____.

9. Nowadays, it is common to _____. Many people like _____ because _____. Besides, _____.

10. _____, just like many other things, are preferred by _____. While being attacked by the idea that _____, some people consider _____. They point that _____.

11. Everything has two sides and _____ is not an exception, it has both advantages and disadvantages.

12. For years _____ had been viewed as _____. But people are taking a fresh look at it now.

13. It has stipulated by the government that _____. To this stipulation, many people respond actively because _____.

14. _____ is a common occurrence in our daily life. Whatever we do, _____ can't be avoided.

15. _____ has become a hot topic among people, especially among the young, and heated debates are right on their way.
16. Recently, _____ has become the focus of the society, and in this way.. People swarm to _____.
17. _____ has been playing an increasingly important role in our day-to-day life. It has brought us a lot of benefits but created some serious problems as well.
18. Man is now facing a big problem-_____, which is becoming more and more serious. First, _____ second, _____.
19. Nowadays more and more people are beginning to be aware of the seriousness of _____.
20. It is only during the last years that man has become generally aware that _____.
21. There is an old saying, _____. It's the experience of our forefathers, however, it is correct in many cases ever today.
22. The English proverb says, _____. This is quite true because _____.
23. _____ is now _____, and at the same time _____. These two factors have caused _____. Then what shall we do to solve _____ in the face of such a situation.
24. One of our ancient philosophers said, _____. Chinese people have always been holding this idea to be one of their standards of morality.
25. One of the great early writers said that _____. If this is true, the present situation should make us ponder over _____.
26. "Why do _____?" Many people often ask questions like this.
27. In recent years, there is a general tendency to _____. According to a study, there is _____ compared with _____ last year. Why _____?
28. According to a survey, there is a growing number of _____. What brings this result? The main reason rests with.
29. Some people prefer to _____. In their opinion, _____. In addition, _____. Nevertheless, nowadays, _____ has become more and more common.

30. Today, there _____, which have brought a lot of harms in our daily life. First, _____ second, _____. What makes things worse is that _____.
31. Nowadays, _____ has become a problem we have to face. Though it's easier said than done, with the help of modern technology, we now have many means to solve it.
32. Many people are inclined to _____. In their opinion, _____. They believe that _____.
33. From the graph/chart, we know the statistics of _____ and _____. It can be seen easily that _____.
34. According to the two graphs presented, it can be observed that _____. In the left graph, _____. At the same time, _____ as the right graph shows.
35. The graph shows the general trend in _____.
36. According to the figures/numbers/statistics/percentages in the table/chart/bar graph/line graph, it can be seen that _____. Obviously, _____, but why?
37. The figure indicates/shows/suggests/proves that _____. There is a steady/rapid development/trend of _____.
38. These days we are often told that _____. But is it true?
39. These days we often hear about _____. But is this really the case?
40. One of the great writers once said that _____. Now it still has a realistic significance.
41. In our history, the idea that _____ never has been so popular. On one hand, _____, on the other hand, _____.
42. There are different opinions among people as to _____. Some people suggest that _____.
43. Some people hold the opinion that _____ is superior to _____ in many ways: Others, however, disagree with it.
44. Nowadays although more and more people _____, still there are some who think _____, they may think _____.

b. 支撑句

Supporting ideas “support”, or explain the idea expressed in the topic sentence. They help to back up, clarify, illustrate, explain or prove the point you make in your topic sentence.

Take a look at the following two examples and answer the following questions based on them:

- a. Is there a topic sentence in the paragraph? Where is it?
- b. How many supporting ideas are given in this paragraph?
- c. How do they support the controlling idea?

New students should give careful consideration to the courses they want to take in their first semester at college. For one thing, they should balance science and non-science courses so that they do not have too many time-consuming labs. They should also try to get a mixture between subjects they find fairly easy and those that are difficult for them. For instance, the student who does well in history but expects to have a terrible time with calculus might plan on taking both in the same semester to balance the workload. The students who does not plan carefully and takes five rough courses the first term may wind up on scholastic probation.

1. The most obvious reason for this phenomenon is that _____.
Consequently, _____.
2. No matter you like it or not, AAA has become more and more popular and there are many reason for it.
3. It's an urgent task for us to change this unfavorable situation: _____.
4. The picture can reminds you of some strange, yet familiar phenomena existing in our society.
5. A great number of solutions are being offered. Some people suggest that _____. Others argue that _____.
6. Confronted with AAA, we should take a serious of effective measures to cope with the situation.
7. However, _____ may cause some problems. First, it is _____. Second, _____. Finally, _____. So, it is clear that _____ has its advantages and disadvantages.

8. Although _____ has a great advantage of _____, it can't compete with _____ in _____.
9. _____ may be preferable to _____, but _____ suffers from the disadvantages that _____.
10. The advantages of _____ are much greater than those of _____. For instance, _____.
11. _____ may be preferable to _____, but it also suffers from the disadvantages that _____.
12. But I don't think it is a very good way to solve _____. For instance, _____. Worst of all, _____.
13. There are many ways to _____. First, _____. Second, _____. Third, _____.
14. On the contrary, there are some people in favor of _____. They believe _____. Moreover, they think _____.
15. There are several measures for us to adopt. First, we can _____, there are a number of advantages of _____. Another solution is to _____.
16. It is high time that something was done about it. For example, _____. In addition, _____. All these measures will certainly _____.
17. There are some other people, who _____. Their reasons are different, something for _____, sometimes for _____, and sometimes simply for _____.
18. _____ is necessary and important to our country's development and construction. First, _____. What's more, _____. Most important of all, _____.
19. However, if not managed properly, _____ can create many problems. Sometimes _____. Furthermore, _____. Therefore, _____ has been gaining public concern.
20. There are probably many reasons for _____. First, _____. Second, _____. Finally, _____.
21. Well, why is there _____? I think there might be two reasons. One is _____, and the other is _____.

22. There are, I think, two main reasons for _____. In the first place, _____. In the second place, _____. Therefore, _____.
23. Why _____? For one thing, _____. For another, _____. Perhaps the main reason is _____.
24. It is no easy job to find the reasons for this tendency which involves several complicated factors. For some _____. For others _____.
25. Why _____? The first reason is that _____. The second reason is _____. The third is _____. For all this, the main cause of _____ is due to _____.
26. It is reasonable to maintain that _____, but it would be foolish to persist that _____. There are three reasons _____.
27. The explanation for this problem involves many factors. For one thing, _____. For another, _____. Still _____.
28. The causes for _____ are varied. They include _____. Perhaps the main cause is _____.
29. The eventual result it brings out is _____. And perhaps the most obvious result of _____ is _____.
30. However, just like everything has both its good and bad sides, _____ also has its own disadvantages, such as, _____. besides, _____.
31. _____ will bring the society many benefits. For one thing, _____. For another thing, _____.
32. Why _____? Some _____. And the most common case is that _____. The notable example is to _____.
33. There are many reasons responsible for this instance, and the following are the typical ones. For one thing, _____, in addition, _____. The main reason is that _____.
34. People had figured out many ways to solve this problem. Firstly _____. Though this method has its good sides like it can _____. One of its bad sides it brings about is that it can _____.
35. Some reasons can explain the trend. First, _____. Second, _____. Third, _____.
36. One of the reasons that is given for _____ is that _____.

37. A further reason why I advocate an attitude of _____ is that _____.
38. What is more, the essence of _____ is that _____, although we cannot, most of us _____.
39. Nonetheless, I reckon that _____ is more advantageous.
40. From a personal perspective, I also prefer to _____ because _____.
41. To make a moral point, I feel that _____ is important for _____ is that _____.
42. The main reason why I feel that _____ is important for _____ is that _____.
43. _____ is superior in several ways, of which perhaps the most fundamental is that _____.
44. There are numerous reasons why _____, and I shall here explore only a few of the most important ones.
45. One very strong argument for _____ is that _____.
46. Moving on to wider themes, many people would argue that _____ is important for _____ because _____.
47. Of course, I am aware that both ways have potential pitfalls.
48. The advantages of _____ carry more weight than those of _____.
49. I can think of better illustration of this idea than the example of _____.
50. Perhaps the most important example of _____ is _____.
51. I fully agree with the statement that _____. The reasons are chiefly as follows.
52. I fully agree with the statement that _____ because _____.
53. As far as I am concerned, my favor goes to _____. The followings are the reasons of my choices. Firstly _____, secondly, _____.
54. Of these two ways of _____, I inclined to this point of view which _____. First of all, _____, secondly, _____.

55. But there are still many people who don't agree. They argue that _____.

56. However, the advantages far outweigh the disadvantages. The idea is easily supported by facts that _____.

57. For all the disadvantages, _____ has its compensating advantages. Firstly _____, secondly, _____.

c. 结尾句

A concluding sentence is the one that restates the controlling idea in different words, summarizes the discussion, or draws an inference based on the foregoing information. Let's take the preceding paragraph for example.

1. The most effective means to solve this problem is that _____. In that case, _____.

2. Everything has its own two sides, no exception with AAA. For one thing, _____. for another, _____.

3. My experience tells me that to _____ needs a thorough and persevering process, and in this process you had better abide by the principles mentioned above.

4. On the whole, it is high time that we recognized the significance of _____.

5. As a result, we should take some effective methods to _____.

6. Judging by the figures, we can draw a conclusion that _____.

7. In a word, the whole society should pay close attention to the problem of _____. Only in this way can _____ in the future.

8. In my opinion, we should place much emphasis on the importance of _____.

9. But _____ and _____ have their own advantages. For example, _____, while _____. Comparing those two, however, I prefer to _____.

10. In my opinion, _____ is just as common as _____. If _____, it may be very useful. Whatever _____, the key point lies in _____.

11. Are their opinions correct? To my mind, the first idea seems _____. As for the second idea, _____.

12. As a popular saying goes, _____. In my opinion what really counts is not _____, but _____. I believe that as long as _____, we will _____. So I am for the opinion that _____.

13. In my opinion, both sides are partly right. When we _____, we should take into consideration all aspects of the problems, and then make the right decision.

14. Personally, I believe that _____. Consequently, I'm confident that a bright future is awaiting us because _____.

15. In my opinion, all of the people should be brave enough to show our disapproval and criticism when confronted with _____.

16. People are coming to realize the importance of _____. They have begun to try their best to _____. We believe that _____.

17. All in all, we cannot live without _____. But at the same time we must try to find out new ways to cope with problems that would arise.

18. Whatever you do, please remember the saying- _____. If you understand it and apply it to your study or work, you'll definitely benefit a lot from it.

19. With the development of society, _____. So it's urgent and necessary to _____. If every member is willing to contribute himself to the society, it will be better and better.

20. It is difficult to say whether _____ is good or not in general as it depends very much on the situation of _____. However, from a personal point of view I find _____.

21. It is essential that effective actions should be taken to end the situation.

22. It is no doubt that special attention must be paid to the problem of _____.

23. But both _____ and _____ have disadvantages. For example, _____. Which to choose, _____ or _____? Careful consideration is necessary before you make your own choice.

24. From what has been discussed above, we may reasonably arrive at the conclusion that _____.

25. We must search for a quick action, because the present situation of _____ is grievous, if allowed to proceed, will certainly lead to _____.
26. No doubt, if we ignore the problem, there is every chance that _____ will be put in danger.
27. We need to take a second look at the matter from a wider standpoint, otherwise, we won't _____.
28. It is high time that _____. Here are some of the measures that might be taken immediately.
29. In conclusion, we should know about the problem of _____, and object to _____. Only in this way _____.
30. Although it is affected by many factors, still there are certain ways that can make the situation better. The most import is _____. Another way is _____. Still another one is _____.
31. Many solutions are offered here, all of them make some sense, but none is adequate enough. The problem should be studied in depth.
32. No easy method can be at hand to solve the problem of _____. But the common recognition of the importance of _____ might be the first step on the right way.
33. It is clear, therefore, that the task of _____ demands great attention.
34. We may have a long way to go before we reach the final goal. But once we are on the way, the chance to reach it is greater.
35. But for me, I would rather think of the matter in an optimistic way. Because I believe _____.
36. We all know the story of _____. this lesson tells us that _____, we should _____.
37. My own point of view is that _____ is a normal behavior in our society. There is no doubt that _____. As an old saying goes, _____.
38. If we can't take useful means, we may not control this trend, and some undesirable result may come out unexpectedly, so what we should do is _____.
39. However, this graph may not predict the entire situation in the future. I believe _____.

40. From the graph it is evident that _____.
41. From all the reasons above, we know that great changes had taken place in _____. And I believe that _____.
42. Taking into account all of these factors, we may reach the conclusion that _____.
43. For the reasons given above, I strongly recommend that _____.
44. Given the factors I have just outlined, I believe that _____.
45. Therefore, it is not difficult to draw the conclusion that _____.
46. Recognizing the fact that _____ should lead us to conclude that _____.
47. In short, I support the statement that it is better to _____ because _____.
48. After pondering this question on many occasions, I have finally reached the conclusion that _____ is something I truly want to do and it is worthwhile.
49. My point of view in _____ largely results from the fact that _____.
50. Now after close examination, it is not difficult to draw the conclusion that _____.
51. From what has been discussed above, you can get your preference. Personally, I think _____ has more advantages.
52. On the one hand, it has helped china _____. On the other hand, it has increased china's _____, and at the same time, made great contributions to our national development.
53. In my opinion, to solve this problem there might be two ways. One way to tackle this question is _____. Another way that is worth adopting is _____.
54. As far as I am concerned, I trust the advantages mentioned above exceed the disadvantages.
55. For me, _____ is a glory and it is the most important thing I have to take into feasible consideration.
56. As regards me, I tend to pick _____, for _____. What's more, _____.

57. If I were given a choice between _____ and _____, I would certainly prefer _____. For me,

2. 优秀段落的本质特点

a. Unity

In a unified paragraph, everything should relate to your paragraph's main point, which usually is expressed in a topic sentence.

Unity means that all the sentences in the paragraph illustrate or explain the main idea, and not any other idea.

Every element in a paragraph must be directly and clearly tied to the central theme, just as each paragraph must be linked to the overall intention of the essay.

Samples:

For various reasons, some unhappy couples remain married. 2. Some are forbidden to divorce by religion, others by social customs. 3. Still others stay together "for the sake of the children." 4. In recent years psychologists and sociologists have studied families to determine whether more harm is done to children by divorce or by parents who stay together despite conflict. 5. By staying together, such parents feel they are sparing their children the pain of divorce.

In the early development of socialism, our country didn't pay much attention to the issue of environmental protection and savored the bitterness. Now, the government has taken many measures and is implementing the strategy of "sustainable development". One aspect of the strategy is to develop the economy and take measures to protect the environment at the same time. In this way, we can develop our country in a sustainable manner and our offspring can have enough resources to develop society. If we don't put much emphasis on the environment issue and excavate the natural resources blindly, our country will become a barren land sooner or later.

Finding a job is one thing, and finding an ideal career is another. Different people prefer different careers, but they all seek for it on some conditions such as interest, major, ability, excellence, etc. With these conditions, one may do his best to finish the job, and bring forth one's deepest potential. Personally, an ideal career is what I like to do, and what helps me fulfill my life. I enjoy the process as well as the result.

b. Coherence

Coherence means “sticking together”. A coherent paragraph is one in which the ideas are put in the right order with the right connecting words so that it is easy for the reader to follow your thought. In a word, in a coherent paragraph, all its supporting information is logically organized and smoothly connected.

1. Coherence Through Logical Development

The best way to make a paragraph coherent is by arranging ideas in a logical pattern that makes sense to your readers. For college essay writing, three ways of development are quite common. They are:

- 1) development by example;
- 2) development by cause and effect analysis;
- 3) development by comparison and contrast.

Sample one

For one thing, the celebrities don't have privacy an ordinary person has. The most personal details of their lives are splashed all over the front pages of the National Enquirer and the Globe so that the bored supermarket shoppers can read about “Liz and Her New Love,” or “Burt's Deepest Fear.” Even a celebrity's family is hauled into the spotlight. A teenage son's arrest for pot possession or wife's drinking problem becomes the subject of glaring headlines. Photographers hound celebrities at their homes, in restaurants, and on the streets, hoping to get a picture of a Jackie Onassis in curlers or a Burt Reynolds in a fistfight. When celebrities try to do something that normal people do, like eating out or attending a football game, they run the risk of being interrupted by thoughtless autograph hounds or mobbed by aggressive fans.

Sample two

During the past five years, the number of Americans killed annually in car accidents has climbed to more than 55,000 and this needless slaughter on streets and highways can be attributed to three general causes. Mechanical failures, especially those related to faulty brakes and bald tires, account for a significant number of fatal accidents. Environmental conditions such as blind corners, narrow streets, heavy fog, intermittent rain or snow resulting in slippery roads also contribute to the grisly accident statistics. But without doubt the most frequently reported factors in car accidents are errors of human judgment—all the way from such follies as excessive speed and drunken driving to such momentary lapses as failures to signal a turn or a change from one lane to another. The man behind the wheel is often his worst enemy.

Sample three

A major difference between the two is how responsible they are. My stepfather has always had a steady job. He enjoys going to work each day and knowing that at the end of the week he'll get a paycheck. With this paycheck he pays bills, buys groceries, and makes sure we all have clothes to wear. On the other hand, my father doesn't particularly care for jobs. He is a singer and has worked three to four nights a week in nightclubs most of his life. With his money, he buys things like new guitars and amplifiers. His idea of providing for us, as Mom tells me, is to send ten dollars a month, which is to be divided three ways. He only does this, however, when he's out of state.

2. Coherence Through Transitional Words and Phrases

Transitional words and phrases signal the curve and direction of the thoughts as you read through the paragraph.

Read the Following Two Paragraphs.

Paragraph A:

Working in the neighborhood grocery store as a checker was one of the worst jobs I've ever had. I had to wear an ugly, scratchy uniform. It was cut at least three inches too short. My schedule of working hours was inconvenient. My hours changed each week. It was impossible to make plans in advance. Getting a day off was out of the question. The lack of working space bothered me. Except for a half-hour break, I was restricted to three square feet of room behind the counter. I felt like a cog in the cash register.

Paragraph B:

Working in the neighborhood grocery store as a checker was one of the worst jobs I've ever had. In the first place, I had to wear an ugly, scratchy uniform cut at least 3 inches too short. My schedule of working hours changed each week, it was impossible to make plans in advance, and getting a day off was out of the question. In addition, the lack of working space bothered me. Except for a half-hour lunch break, I was restricted to three feet of room behind the counter and consequently i felt as if I were no more than a cog in the cash register.

Common Transitional Expressions

1. 表举例: for example, for instance, as an example, as an illustration, such as

2. 表比较: similarly, likewise, in the same way, in common
3. 表对照: on the contrary, on the other hand, otherwise, unlike, in contrast, whereas, conversely, by contrast, while
4. 表让步: although, nevertheless, however, but, admittedly, even though, in spite of
5. 表原因: because, because of, as, since, for, owing to, due to, on account of
6. 表结果: thus, so consequently, hence, therefore, accordingly, as a result
7. 表强调: chiefly, especially, in deed, in fact, certainly, particularly, actually
8. 表列举: first, second, in the first place, first of all, to begin with, in the second place, furthermore, moreover, for one thing, for another
9. 表总结: in conclusion, in short, in brief, in summary, on the whole, to sum up, to conclude

3. Coherence Through Repeated Key Terms

Key terms may be repeated throughout the paragraph to link sentences. The key terms are italicized in the following paragraph:

The key words are often repeated in different forms: simple repetition of the original wording; repetition by means of derivatives, synonyms and sometimes antonyms.

Sample One:

The controversy over Northgate Mall has continued for at least five years. The dispute has divided the city into two camps. A small group seems opposed to the mall, but its members are vocal and energetic. The opponents maintain that it would rob trade from existing businesses downtown and contribute to traffic congestion. Proponents say that the growth it would bring would be easily manageable.

Sample Two:

One serious problem facing our school is student absenteeism. Although the problem has many causes, one of the most obvious is the fact that students are not penalized for such absenteeism. They can miss several days of school and suffer no consequences. There is no punishment meted out to them or their parents, even when the absence is unexcused. And they are not penalized academically. They still pass despite many absences. A friend of mine, for example, has missed forty-two days of school this year. He has not had a single detention and has passed every single subject.

A. 篇章结构

The Gloom Room

On this dreary October afternoon in my writing class here on the second floor of Boylan Hall at Brooklyn College, a shadow of gloom hangs over the people and things that surround me. The atmosphere is depressing. There is an old brown chair beside the teacher's desk, a mahogany bookcase with a missing shelf, and this ugly desk of mine filled with holes and scratches. As I rub my hand across its surface, there is a feeling of coldness. Even the grey walls and the rumble of thunder outside reflect the atmosphere of seriousness as we write our first theme of the semester. When some air sails through an open window beside me, there is the annoying smell of coffee grounds from a garbage pail not far off. My classmates, too, show this mood of tension. Mary, a slim blonde at my right, chews frantically the inside of her lower lip. Only one or two words in blue ink stand upon her clean white page. David Harris, slouched in his seat in the third row, nibbles each finger of each hand. Then he plays inaudibly with a black collar button that stands open on the top of his red plaid shirt. There is a thump as he uncrosses his legs and his scuffed shoe hits the floor. A painful cough slices the air from behind me. I hear a woman's heels click from the hall beyond the closed door and car engine whine annoyingly from Bedford Avenue. If a college classroom should be a place of delight and pleasure, it could never be proved by the tension in this room.

The Gloom Room

October often looks and feels dreary because school is by then in full swing. Today, a rainy Thursday, is no different. What makes it worse is that I am forced to sit in my writing class on the second floor of Boylan Hall at Brooklyn College and write a theme. It is no wonder that a shadow of gloom hangs over the things and the people that surround me in this room.

As I look around, I see that the surroundings are old and depressing. There is a broken brown chair beside the teacher's desk; no one will sit in it for fear of leaning back and toppling over onto the floor. There is also a mahogany bookcase with a missing shelf, and all the books are piled on the bottom in a stack of blue and yellowed covers, instead of standing in a straight row. This ugly desk of mine is filled with holes and scratches because other impatient students, no doubt, lost their tempers and took out their anger on the wooden surface. As I rub my hand across it, I feel coldness. Even the gray walls and the rumble of thunder outside reflect the

atmosphere of seriousness as we write our first theme of the semester. When some air sails through an open window beside me, there is the annoying smell of coffee grounds from a garbage pail not far off. [That smell is a perfect indication of our discomfort.]

[Aside from the unattractive surroundings,] [the people around me show this mood of tension and displeasure.] Mary, a slim blonde at my right, chews the inside of her lower lip. I can see by the way her forehead is wrinkled that she is having quite a bit of trouble. Because only one or two words in blue ink stand upon her clean white page, she looks around the room fearfully for some new ideas. Slouching in his seat in the third row, David Harris nibbles each finger of each hand. Then he plays with a black collar button that stands open on the top of his red plaid shirt. The tension gets to him, too. Drops of perspiration run slowly down his cheeks. I hear a thump as he uncrosses his legs and his scuffed shoe hits the floor. A painful cough slices the air from behind me. I hear a woman's heels click from the hall beyond the closed door and a car engine whine annoyingly from Bedford Avenue. All these signs of gloom do not help my mood at all.

The last few painful moments make me wonder if what my friends told me about college was all true. Where are all the beautiful girls I'm supposed to be meeting and talking to in every room? Where are the freedom and relaxed atmosphere my friends bragged about? I'm supposed to be enjoying myself instead of suffering! Everybody seems to have forgotten that college is hard work too. My first days in writing class prove that delight and pleasure often disappear when assignments are due!

A. Summary of the Organizational Structure of a Typical English Composition

1. The number of Paragraphs: A typical English composition should consist of a maximum number of 5 paragraphs so that the students can support each body paragraph with sufficient supporting ideas.

2. Their respective functions:

Introductory paragraph: It is supposed to introduce the subject matter; in the meanwhile, it tries to captivate the reader's attention and arouse interest. Besides, it must present a thesis statement, which embodies the main idea of the whole composition.

Body paragraphs: They serve to illustrate or to substantiate each one of the aspects made clear in the thesis statement.

Concluding paragraph: it brings the whole composition to a natural conclusion by summary, restatement, or by drawing an inference.

B. How to Formulate a Thesis Statement (主旨句的撰写)

A thesis statement contains two parts: the topic and your assertion or view of the

topic – what you intend to say about the topic.

The thesis statement is similar to the topic sentence in that it contains an expression of an attitude, opinion or idea about a topic. Unlike the T. S., however, the thesis statement is broader and expresses the controlling idea for the entire essay. In fact, each of the developmental paragraphs should have a controlling idea that echoes or relates to the controlling idea in the thesis statement.

a. Characteristics of a Good Thesis Statement (主旨句的撰写)

1. It should be expressed in a complete sentence. 句子结构完整

e. g.: My fear of the dark.

e. g.: Homes and Schools

2. It expresses an opinion, attitude, or idea; it does not simply announce the topic the essay will develop. 提出个人观点

e. g.: I am going to discuss the effects of radiation.

e. g.: This paper will tell you something about the problems of conserving our natural resources.

e. g.: I want to share some thoughts about our space program.

3. It should express an opinion instead of presenting a fact. The thesis statement is one that needs to be explained or proved.

e. g.: Cows produce milk.

e. g.: The capital of California is Sacramento.

e. g.: President Lincoln's first name was Abraham.

4. It should be neither too broad nor too vague. 话题的讨论范围适中

e. g.: The world is in a terrible mess.

e. g.: Crime must be stopped.

e. g.: Hemingway's war stories are very good.

e. g.: Drug addiction is a big problem.

e. g.: There are many advantages and disadvantages to going to college.

b. Practice: Improve upon the following thesis statements

1. People are too selfish.

2. Sean Connery: Hollywood Great

3. The Fad of Divorce

4. The thesis of this paper is the difficulty of solving our environmental problems.

5. Jane Austen is the author of Pride and Prejudice.

6. Suicide is the deliberate taking of one's own life.

7. Crime must be stopped.

c. Good Advice: Structuring the Thesis 主旨句应具有清晰的结构

Your thesis statement should be one sentence that has two parts—a general idea and specific points. The general idea will be the overall topic of your composition. The specific points will be the two, three or four precise areas that you use to prove or support the general idea. These points will determine and set your boundaries or limits. In effect, the thesis states that the general idea is true because of these facts.

Thesis: General idea = fact one + fact two + fact three

Thesis: Love is like a rose: both are born, mature and die.

Thesis: College students fit into three classifications according to their attentiveness in class: “Dreamy Dave,” “Squiring Slim,” and “Studious Sam.”

Thesis: Drug addiction leads to social withdrawal, self-alienation, and disdain for the future.

Thesis: In “A Rose for Emily,” William Faulkner relies on title, symbol, and atmosphere to state his theme that time waits for no man, although many try to stop it.

Thesis: The immortality of A Dream in Red Mansions lies in that it portrays the characters vividly and lively, it contains a wide range of knowledge, and it presents the society of late Feudal China.

III. 考研英语短文写作

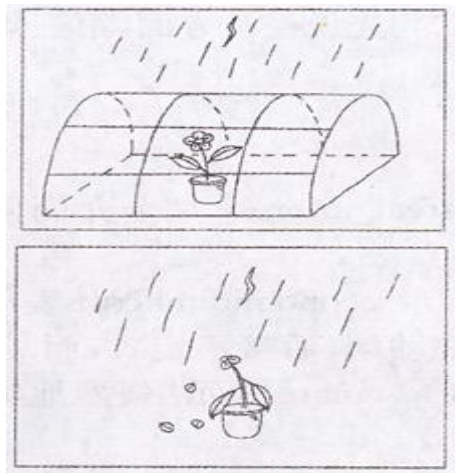
1. 段落策略

引言段(Introduction)

Strategy A – Description of the Cartoon

常用句:

Sample 1: A Flower in a Greenhouse



Sample 2:



Strategy B – Use a Quotation

As the saying goes, “Health is the wealth”. Due to fast pace of life and fierce competition, people are faced with high pressure from life and work, which results in both physical and mental problems. So more and more people are concerned about health. They are taking whatever measures as they see fit to improve their health

...

As the saying goes, “Haste makes waste”. We are now living in an age of rapid pace and high efficiency. Everyone wants to achieve the quickest result within the shortest time. But if too much emphasis is put on speed, people will ignore the quality of what they are doing, and this may yield unsatisfying results.

- As the saying goes,...
- It is often said that...

- People often say that...
- One of the great men once said/ remarked/ that...
- It is often quoted that...
- According to a(n) recent (new / official) study (survey / report / poll),....
- Failure is the mother of success.
- A life without a friend is a life without a sun.
- The important thing in life is to have a great aim, and the determination to attain it.
- There is no end to learning.
- A good medicine tastes bitter.
- Honesty is the best policy
- Actions speak louder than words.
- Look before you leap.
- To read without reflection is like eating without digesting.
- Where there is a will, there is a way.
- Well begun is half done.
- Never put off until tomorrow what can be done today.
- When in Rome, do as the Romans do.
- Time and tide wait for no man.
- To idle one's time amounts to killing oneself.

Strategy C – Description of the Chart / Table

1. The number / percentage of ... nearly / almost doubled / tripled as against / as opposed to / compared with that of last year.
2. As is described in the chart, the past two centuries has witnessed a dramatic rise / fall in ...
3. The figure / percentage is twice / four times as much as that / those of 1990.
4. compared with 1990, it increased / rose / decreased / dropped / fell by X percent from X to Y percent

5. It accounts for / makes up 32 % of the total.
6. From 1990 to 1998, there was a sudden / sharp/ marked / steady / slight jump / rise / increase / fluctuation / decline
7. The percentage reached a peak / a high point / low point in March.

Sample One:

第一段：描写图表/图画

Year	2000	2003	2006
Number of private cars	7,200,000	13,000,000	22,000,000

主体段 (Body)

1. 比较 (Comparison)

a. From the pictures we can see that there is much similarity between the spoiled children and the greenhouse flowers. Just like the greenhouse, some parents assume that it is their obligation to sweep away all the blocks on their way for their children. Instant help is given to the children faced with difficulties. What's more, young people are spoiled by being allowed to do everything they want. So self-centeredness and arbitrariness have become a trait of the young people.

b. Although Ulysses S. Grant and Robert E. Lee were fierce adversaries/ rivals during the Civil War, their lives, both military and nonmilitary, has a great deal in common. Grant descended from a family whose members participated in the American Revolution. He received his commission of second lieutenant from West Point and served in the Spanish-American War. He was later summoned by President Lincoln to assume command of the Union Forces during the Civil War. After the Civil War, Grant suffered financial problems and was forced to declare bankruptcy. Lee also descended from a family which engaged in the American Revolution. He, too, received his commission from West Point and later fought in Mexico during the Spanish-American War. His fame as a military strategist during the Civil War, when he was the commander of the Confederate armies, is well known. Although it is not always pointed out by historians he, like Grant, had financial difficulties after the civil War and was compelled to declare bankruptcy. By securing a post as president of Washington College, he was able to avoid additional poverty.

比较常用句型：

- A and B have a lot/ little in common.

- A is similar to B in (temperament, character, geography...)
- A bears remarkable resemblance to B.

Topics for Practice:

- Compare two (celebrities, games, types of music, advertisements, and TV programs).

2. 对比 (Contrast)

a. The set of pictures reflects two different kinds of philosophies as to how economy should be developed. In the first case, in mad pursuit of economic profits, some enterprises and manufacturers have turned a blind eye to the protection of our environment and the preservation of natural resources. As a result, nature has to pay a heavy price for each so-called progress man has made. In the latter case, with a view to achieving sustainable economic growth, some local governments and factories are attaching great importance to developing environment-friendly industries and have taken some proper measures to strike a balance between environment and economic development. Obviously, the second mode of thinking contributes to the harmony between man and nature.

b. Hundreds of studies show that optimists and pessimists have completely different characteristics from each other, which accounts for the different consequences. The optimists believe that defeat is just a temporary setback, that its causes are confined to this one case. They are not bothered by defeat. Confronted by a bad situation, they perceive it as a challenge and try harder. In addition, optimists do much better in school and at work. They regularly exceed their predictions of aptitude tests. When optimists run for office, they are more apt to be elected. Moreover, evidence suggests that the health of the optimists is unusually good. They may even live longer. Pessimists, on the contrary, tend to believe that bad events will last a long time, will undermine everything they do, and are their own fault. Studies show that pessimists give up more easily and get depressed more often, the possible result of which is that they will get physically sick more often.

比较常用句型:

- A is slightly / drastically different from / differs from B in...
- There is a sharp contrast between A and B in...

Topics for Practice:

- Contrast two (outlooks on life, approaches to problem solving, models of cars, computers...).

3. 因果分析

a. The problems mirrored in the first picture are by no means a coincidence. As a matter of fact, they can be attributed to a number of factors. To begin with, in the early development of socialism, China failed to pay much attention to the issue of environmental protection and to make rigid laws to protect our environment. Besides, in some industries such as paper-making and printing, China still lags far behind some advanced countries in its treatment of sewage and waste materials. Last but not the least, it is not uncommon for some enterprises to adopt some primitive methods of production, simply to pursue maximum economic profits in the short run. However, this is achieved only at the expense of our natural environment and the deterioration of our life.

b. Reforms have already brought the Chinese people a lot of benefits. As a result of successful economic reforms in urban and rural areas, great improvement has been made in the people's living standards. The political reform has also showed its great advantages. It strengthens and perfects our political system and creates better conditions for the further development of production. What's more, reforms have enriched the people's spiritual life and now people can enjoy more democracy.

因果分析常用语句:

- The increase (change / failure / success) in... is due to (owing to / attributable to) the fact that....
- One may attribute (ascribe / owe) the increase (decrease / change) to..., but... is not by itself an adequate explanation.
- There are many (different / several / a number of / a variety of) causes (reasons) for this dramatic (marked / significant) growth (change / decline / increase) in.... First,.... Second,.... Finally,....
- It gives rise to (lead to / bring / create) a host of problems (consequences).
- There are numerous reasons why..., and I shall here explore only a few of the most important ones.
- A multitude of factors could account for (contribute to / lead to / result in / influence) the change (increase / decrease / success / failure / development) in....

- This kind of phenomenon is not entirely a coincidence. There exist several factors behind this trend. To begin with, as ..., Thus, In addition, Even worse, due to ...,
- It will exert (have / produce) profound (far-reaching / remarkable / considerable / beneficial / favorable / undesirable / disastrous) effect (influence) on....
- With the development (improvement / rise / growth / general recognition / acknowledgement / realization) of..., vast changes awaits this country's society.

Topics for Practice:

- Analyze the causes and impact of global climate change.
- Analyze the popularity of (a star, a new model of car, a band...).
- Analyze the necessity of global cooperation.
- Analyze the impact of science on human society.

4. 举例说明

a. The immortality of *A Dream in Red Mansions* lies in the fact that it portrays the characters vividly and lively. The novel has created memorable characters regardless of its complicated plot and tangled affairs. Wang Xifeng is a sharp-tongued astute woman who caters to her upper class but is severe to her lower class. Lin Daiyu is a beautiful, weak and sentimental girl who wants to pursue true love yet is unable to win over the feudal ideas on marriage. Other characters like Jia Baoyu, Xue Baochai and so on are all portrayed so well that if one is given some descriptions about each character, he can distinguish them easily.

b. Knowledge often results only after persistent investigation. Albert Einstein, after a lengthy examination of the characteristics of matter and energy, formulated his famous Theory of Relativity, which now acts as a basis for further research in nuclear physics. Using plaster casts of footprints, fingerprints, and stray strands of hair, a detective pertinaciously pursues the criminal. After years of work Annie Jump cannon perfected the classification of the spectra of some 350,000 stars. Investigations into the causes of polio have provided us with the means for prevention and cure of this dreaded disease only after many years of research. As students, we are determined in our investigation to find, retain, and contribute to the store of human knowledge.

举例常用句型:

- History (Our society) is filled (abounds) with the examples of....
- The story (case / instance / situation) is not rare (isolated / unique), it is one of many examples (typical of dozens).
- A good case in point is....

Topics for Practice:

- Reading makes a full man.
- Travel broadens the mind.
- Technology is changing our lives

5. 正反论证

a. Self-confidence is of great importance to an individual. With invincible confidence, one can aspire after the great dream of becoming a glamorous actor, a prestigious scientist, and even a first-class sportsman in the face of insurmountable trouble and even disabling diseases. On the other hand, without a proper sense of self-belief, one can hardly take any initiative in his work for fear of ridicule, let alone envision a bold dream for himself. In that case, life is but a broken-winged bird that cannot fly.

b. Moreover, our life is nothing more than our time. To kill time is therefore a form of suicide. We are shocked when we think of death, and we spare no pains, no trouble, and no expense to preserve life. But we are too often indifferent to the loss of an hour or of a day, forgetting that our life is the sumtotal of the days and of the hours we live. A day or an hour wasted is therefore so much life forfeited. Let us bear this in mind, and waste of time will appear to us in the light of a crime as culpable as suicide itself.

Topics for Practice:

- Reading makes a full man.
- Travel broadens the mind.
- Technology is changing our lives.

6. 以小见大

a. Undoubtedly, the cartoon conveys the meaning that life is like the process of

running, in which everyone should make constant efforts and never stop making progress. To be specific, this principle applies to individuals, who are born to such a competitive world where once a person stops making progress, he can hardly maintain his past glory and survive the pressure. In addition, the country on the whole should keep moving forward in terms of politics, economy and culture so that we Chinese as a nation can gain sustained respect.

7. 下定义

a. Youth means a temperamental predominance of courage over timidity, of the appetite for adventure over the love of ease. This often exists in a man of 60 more than a boy of 20. Nobody grows old merely by a number of years; we grow old by deserting our idea.

b. Ambition is the decision one makes and the resolution with which he carries out that decision. Our ambition renders us a sense of mission. Caesar of the ancient Roman Empire was urged by his ambition “I came, I saw, I conquered.” And became an unrivalled empire builder in the history of Rome. John Milton, stimulated always by his ambition that aimed at writing some “mighty lines” which England would unwillingly forget, had in due time secured his position as the second Shakespeare in the history of English literature.

Topics for Practice:

➤ Honesty / Ambition / Friendship/ love / honor ...

结论段 (Conclusion)

1. 建议措施 (making some suggestions)

In view of such alienation within families, urgent steps must be taken. For members of families who live away from one another, regular contact on the phone and family reunions on holidays can make a difference. For those living together, it is a good idea to take some time off work to spend more time with each other. In the final analysis, a close family relationship can surely be maintained as long as we realize the significant role it plays in our lives and attach importance to it.

2. 对未来进行预期 (Speculating about the Future)

a. As Chinese citizens, we should respect our own national culture and learn useful things from the cultures of different nations, which will enable us to make great progress in many ways. I believe a happy and bright future is awaiting us if we make every effort to promote cultural development both nationally and internationally.

b. Personally, I embrace frequent well-intentioned cultural exchanges. Not only is such communication conducive to spreading the very essence of our Chinese culture worldwide, it also presents before us the flower of the alien cultures and thus compels us to reexamine the dregs of our culture in confrontation with the foreign ones. Therefore, I believe consistent efforts should be made to enhance international cultural exchanges. We look forward to the day when people all over the world can benefit from cultural contacts and enjoy a kaleidoscopic cultural life.

3. 举例说明

常用结尾句:

- There is little doubt (no denying) that serious (special / adequate / immediate / further) attention must be called (paid / devoted) to the problem of....
- It is necessary (essential / fundamental) that effective (quick / proper) action (steps / measures / remedies) should be taken to prevent (correct / check / end / fight) the situation (tendency / phenomenon).
- It is hoped (suggested / recommended) that great (continuous / persistent / sustained / corporate) efforts should be made to control (check / halt / promote) the growth (increase / rise) of....
- It is hoped that great efforts should be directed to (expended on / focused on) finding (developing / improving)....
- Anyhow, wider (more) education (publicity) should be given to the possible (potential / grave / serious / pernicious) consequences (effects) of....
- To reverse (check / control) the trend (tendency) is not a light task (an easy job), and it requires (demands / involves / entails) a different state of mind towards (attitude towards / outlook on)....
- For these reasons, I strongly recommend that...
- It is imperative / important / essential / high time that..., appeal to sb. to do; take drastic / effective / tough measures to do...; only when..., can we do...
- Evidently, it is imperative for us to take actions to To crack this hard nut, at

least two measures should be taken immediately. For one thing, For another,

2. 体裁策略

An argumentative essay must

- 1) be committed to one side, i.e. the author may not stay neutral to the issue considered;
- 2) refer to external evidence (facts, published expert opinions, statistics, etc) rather than only personal experience, i.e.) to argue rationally.
- 3) take notice of, and convincingly refute, the opposite view(s).

Introduction: Introduce the Controversy and Present Your Personal Stance on the issue.

引入议论文的常用句型:

- There is a public controversy nowadays over the issue of.... Those who object to...argue that.... But people who favor..., on the other hand, argue that....
- Currently (In recent years / In the past few years / For many years now), there is (has been) a(n) general (widespread / growing / widely held) feeling towards (concern over / attitude towards / trend towards / awareness of / realization of / illusion of / belief in)....

议论文常用于驳斥的语句:

- As opposed to (Contrary to) widely (commonly / generally) held (accepted) belief (ideas / views), I believe (argue) that...
- Although many people believe that..., I doubt (wonder) whether the argument bears much analysis (close examination).
- The advantages of B outweigh any benefit we gained from (carry more weight than those of / are much greater than) A.
- There is an element of truth in this argument (statement), but it ignores a deeper and more basic (important / essential) fact (reason) that....
- It is true that (True, / To be sure, / Admittedly,...), but it doesn't follow / it doesn't mean that....

- It would be possible (natural / reasonable) to think (believe / take the view) that..., but it would be absurd (wrong) to claim (argue) that....
- There is absolutely (in fact) no (every) reason for us to believe (accept / resist / reject) that....
- A close (careful) inspection (examination / scrutiny) of this argument would reveal how flimsy (groundless / fallacious) it is.
- The danger (problem / fact / truth / point) is that....
- Now it is commonly (widely / generally / increasingly) believed (thought / held / accepted / felt / recognized / acknowledged) that.... But I wonder (doubt) whether....
- Although the popular belief is that..., a current (new / recent) study (survey / poll / investigation) indicates (shows / demonstrates) that....

Conclusion: Restate the main idea 重申主题思想

Sample 1:

Better Weaponry or Poverty Relief?

Although we are now living in a peaceful world, many countries are still spending astronomical sums on armaments for self-defense. Some people accordingly argue that these monetary resources should be spent on the elimination of poverty. Personally, I agree with this view for 3 reasons.

First, peace and development are the theme of the world. In the 21st century, all nations are vying with one another for economic strength and development. In this case, any country that prizes “defense” as the national priority is wasting valuable national resources. It will lose the opportunity of greater economic development in the new millennium.

Second, elimination of poverty should always be a national priority. Only when a country has achieved economic development, can a country ensure its say in world affairs, secure its sovereignty and territorial integrity.

Third, when a country is spending beyond its means on weapons, it will threaten world peace. Other countries will be tempted to do the same for fear of an imminent attack only at the cost of the welfare of the countries concerned and even the world at large.

In conclusion, national defense within limits is necessary, but too much of it might as well be counter-productive. In a world where all people cherish peace, a country should shift their priority from arms race to economic development.

Sample 2:

Human Cloning Is Wrong

I bet many of you have seen Star Wars, Jurassic Park, or many of the other movies that describe cloning. They are indeed fascinating visions of our future. What you don't know is that human cloning is unethical, for it can be dangerous, to the clone and to our society as a whole.

What about identity? Humans are guaranteed the right to their own personality. What would happen if we overrode those rights by giving them someone else's genetic identity?

Also, there is a large power struggle here. Cloning involves a degree of power and control over another person's physical identity and that violates their rights and degrades their unique individuality. The person doing the cloning would have more power than any parent would have.

Cloning would also deal with killing embryos. You might not have known, but Dolly was one of over 200 sheep embryos and hers was the only embryo that survived. The rest died or were thrown away. But we can't afford so many deaths while experimenting with man.

So, should we forge ahead in the world of cloning? No, the risks outweigh the benefits. We would be killing innocent human lives in the process. It would also be a violation of the clone's right to its own genetic identity and individuality.

Sample 3:

Violence in Video Games

I believe that violence in video games, music, and movies is not to blame at all for violence in society. I believe that these things do the total opposite and allow us to vent some of the built-up anger we have that leads to violence. In fact, I would say the media just gives people who are violent what they want: movies and games are only a scapegoat.

It enrages me when people tell me video games cause violence. In videogames, it is sometimes possible to be a violent character and hurt others, and people think blindly that makes the people who play them more violent. For me, if I am mad, playing such a game vents out my anger and I am no longer mad, and no one has been hurt.

The same goes for music and movies. If I watch a movie and someone gets killed, it is not going to make me go kill someone like in the movie. How much do people actually get away with killing in movies? The villain usually dies, and that doesn't

sound very good to me. Music is just that, music, and nothing more. If I were to start listening to music with violent lyrics, it would not make me become violent at all. If I am violent in the first place and listen to the violent lyrics, it is not the music's fault that I was violent.

When the media looks for attention, they usually report on things like this. It is always negative, and it always attracts attention. People never think about what is being said, they just believe it. When there is a disaster, the media just glorifies it to attract attention to itself. If such a disaster is a terrorist act, the media is just giving them (terrorists) the attention they want, while all the time blaming the problem on video games, music, and movies and TV.

3. 句型策略:

1. 避免常见语病

a. 串句 (run-on sentences)

- a. I took a lot of vitamin C, however, I still came down with the flu.
- b. Ken started wearing a wig, everyone complimented him on how young he looked.
- c. The computer is like TV, it has both advantages and disadvantages.
- d. David writes about many of the events of our time, he has received numerous awards for his work. The praise that David has received for his nonfiction writing is due in large part to his blunt style he always says what he means. He was critical of the media's involvement in the 1988 presidential election, he said so openly. He leads the readers through his thought processes, rarely is any point unsubstantiated.

b. 悬垂修饰语 (dangling Modifiers)

- f. Before submitting any written work, careful proofreading must be done.
- g. Although tired and exhausted, the work was finished on time.

c. 错置修饰语

- i. I nearly earned a hundred dollars last week.
- j. Bill yelled at the howling dog in his underwear.
- k. He killed the wasp that stung him with a newspaper.

d. 语句累赘 (wordiness)

- l. In my opinion, I think it is certain that you will be recognized.

m. This machine was jointed designed by the old engineer in collaboration with some of his younger colleagues

n. There was a pine tree that stood like a giant on the top of the mountain. It towered over the trees around it.

o. Mr. Smith usually likes to drink all kinds of wine that are produced in France.

e. 代词随意转换 (awkward shift in pronoun)

p. Each of us may take a part-time job to help support ourselves, but if you spend too much time on it, your study will be affected.

q. If one is determined and willed to be rejected, you can do quite well as a salesman.

f. 错误的排比句 (faulty parallelism)

r. I was told to report to the supervisor and that I should bring my tools.

s. We should strive to cooperate with our colleagues to bring about change, for improving communication and professional development.

t. Our new car not only is more economical but also it is more comfortable than our old one.

u. Many people choose air transportation because it is fast, offers convenience, and it is not very expensive.

g. 破句 (sentence fragments)

v. When demand for goods was shrinking. Firms would close down or lay off workers.

w. Bill has enormous endurance. For example, the ability to lift weights for three hours and then play basketball all afternoon

x. I am the only woman I know who plays all kinds of card games for money. Such as poker, bridge and blackjack.

h. 汉式英语

y. Because it is quite reasonable in price and fashionable in design, so I bought it without much hesitation.

z. Although an opportunity is rare, but we must be ready to seize it.

aa. There is no doubt that proper physical activities keep our bodies fit.

- bb. My level of English has thus been improved.
- cc. People now have condition to eat good things.
- dd. Just open the TV set, you can know everything, and won't have to go out.
- ee. TV can widen our eyes.
- ff. Young people are now living in sugar water.
- gg. We should put our heart into the study.
- hh. In a society where men are heavy and women are light, women cannot enjoy full equality.
- ii. People set off firecrackers to congratulate the red and white happy things.
- jj. We should advocate five talks and four beauties.
- kk. Those are my humble opinions.

2. 避免句式单一，力求句式多样化

- a. Tiger Woods is the name of a young American golfer. He set a record in the 1997 Master's Tournament. He surprised all the veterans. He was 22 at the time. (long sentence)
- b. Peter and Carl walk to school. Bonnie follows them. Bonnie is Peter's dog. She is a nice dog. She walks at Peter's heels. She turns back at the butcher's shop. Now Bonnie will try to find her friends. She may go home.

3. 语言表达策略

原词	候选替换词	原句
people ,persons	individuals,characters, folks	Many people do not accept it as a good idea that...
good	positive, favorable, rosy(美好的), promising (有希望的), perfect, pleasurable , excellent, outstanding	He puts forward a good plan that...
bad	dreadful, unfavorable, poor, adverse(有害的) be lessimpressive	Frankly to say, this kind of idea is bad.
many	an army of, an ocean of, a sea of, a	Many individuals, if not most,

	multitude of , “many,if not most”	harbor the idea that
some	a slice of, quite a few , several	Quite a few people hold the idea that...
think	harbor the idea that, take the attitude that, hold the view that, it is widely shared that, it is universally acknowledged that	He thinks that...
thing	affair ,business ,matter	He had a lot of things to care.
common	shared	For these people, their common idea is that
Get good result	reap huge fruits, fruitful	Our plan would get us good result.
in my opinion	for my part ,from my own perspective	In my opinion, we should...
more and more	Increasing(ly),growing	More and more people think that...sth has gained more and more popularity
hardly	little if anything, 或 little or nothing 代替	We can hardly find the advantage of his plan.
helpful	beneficial rewarding	His advice is helpful. His hard word is helpful to his success.
customer	shopper,client,consumer,purchaser,	Many customers made the complaint that...
very	exceedingly,extremely	He works very hard, so...
necessary	hardly unnecessary, indispensable	It is necessary for us to...
Be interested in	sth appeals to sb, sth exerts a tremendous fascination on sb	She is so interested in hiking.
attract one'sattention.	capture one's attention beobsessed by(被...迷住)	This theory attracted our attention.
Be busy with	Be occupied in	Recently, he has been busy with doing chores.
cause	give rise to, lead to, result in, trigger	His absence caused our failure.
There are several reasons for sth	There are several reasons behind sth	There are several reasons for people's disappointment about...

Must(动词)	A must (名词)	We must take actions to...
pay attention to	pour attention into, attention be given to	Many people pay attention to the idea that...
remember	bear in mind that	When taking about..., we should remember that...
have	possess	He had a huge house. This idea has the advantage that...
be against , disagree with	frown on sth.	As a matter of fact, many people disagree with the idea that...
for example	to name only a few, as an example	He like all kinds of sports, for example, swimming, hiking and playing football.
use	Employ	Different methods have been used to ...
spend	Occupy	We had spent three days to finish the job.
Action, measure	moves	We should take actions to stop that.
improve	better	This book could better your understanding of Chinese culture.
Improve, develop	perfect	We should do something to perfect our plan.
Better than	Dwarf, wither	His excellent performance really dwarfed/withered ours.

翻译下列常用句子，避开低级词汇短语，同时注意通用结构的准确性。

1. 随着科技的进步，手机的价格越来越便宜。
2. 解决这个问题，需要大家的共同努力。
3. 越来越多的人去参加各种选秀。(talent show)
4. 在我看来，多个因素可以解释这个社会现象。(account for sth.)
5. 我认为，我们应该采取理智的态度来看这个问题。(take a ...attitude towards sth.)

6. 对我们来说，我们应该增强环保意识。（enhance one's awareness in sth.）
7. 在我看来，机遇只垂青那些有所准备的人。
8. 反对者认为，大学生创业弊大于利。
9. 有些人认为，我们对待西方文化应该是宽容的，因此星巴克没必要迁出故宫。
10. 有些人认为，龙是封建皇权的代表，不能代表所有中国人。
11. 现在很多娱乐节目对儿童的成长已经产生了很多负面影响。
12. 我们应该保留中医的优点，去除其糟粕。
13. 网上购物有着传统购物无法比拟的优势。
14. 手机短信也会给人们的生活带来很多不便和干扰。
15. 参加选秀是一个发挥自己潜能，帮助个人成长的机会，因此应该提倡。
16. 很多人为了参加选秀比赛，放弃了学习和工作，只是为了一夜成名，因此不应该鼓励这种行为。
17. 我认为，有钱未必幸福，但没有钱必然不会幸福的。（not necessarily）
18. 在一个团队里，竞争和合作同等重要，前者促使个人努力提高自己的成绩，而后者保证整个团队的胜利。
19. 我们必须学会用科学的方法来缓解学习、工作、生活的各种各样的压力。
20. 出国留学未必能比在国内读书更容易实现个人价值，这毕竟要取决于个人的实际情况。

改写下列句子，将其中的低级词汇、短语改造成中高级形式。

- 1、More and more people have realized the seriousness of the issue.
- 2、In my opinion, there are all kinds of reasons for this phenomenon.

- 3、 In a word, we should take effective measures to solve the problem.
- 4、 In spite of the advantages of short messages, they are not without any limitations.
- 5、 Idol worship has bad effects on the growth of teenagers.
- 6、 The government should make laws to protect the environment.

句子表达练习答案:

1. With the development of technology, the prices of cell phones have been declining.
2. The resolution of this problem calls for our concerted efforts.
3. An increasing number of people participate in a variety of talent shows.
4. To the best of my knowledge, several factors can be identified to account for this social phenomenon.
5. To the best of my understanding, it is advisable that we take a rational attitude towards this issue.
6. On our part, we are supposed to enhance our awareness in environment protection.
7. To the best of my understanding, opportunities are only prepared for those who are prepared.
8. The opponents maintain that the disadvantages far outweigh the advantages when college students start their own businesses.
9. Some people argue that we are supposed to be tolerant with western culture, and thus Starbucks need not move out of the ImperialPalace.
10. Some people maintain that dragon is the representative of the feudal imperial power, and cannot represent all Chinese people.
11. Nowadays, some entertainment shows have generated negative effects upon the growth of young children.
12. It is sensible that we preserve the finest of Traditional Chinese Medicine and

meanwhile eliminate its scum.

13. Online shopping boasts advantages where traditional shopping is not comparable.
14. Cell phone short messages may also bring a great many inconveniences and troubles to people's life.
15. Participating in talent shows is an opportunity that can realize your potential and help you develop, and hence is supposed to be advocated.
16. In order to participate in talent shows, a great many people give up their work or studies, just for the purpose of gaining fame overnight. Thus, it is not supposed to be encouraged.
17. I believe money may not necessarily make us happy, but the lack of it will never.
18. Competition and cooperation are equally vital in a team, the former prompting one to improve his/her performance, while the latter ensuring the success of the whole team.
19. It is sensible that we employ scientific methods to relieve the variety of stresses from academic studies, work and life.
20. Going abroad for further education may not necessarily realize one's personal value more easily than pursuing academic goals at home. After all, it all depends on one's actual situation.

句子改造:

1. An increasing number of people have realized the seriousness of the issue.
2. To the best of my knowledge, several factors can be identified to account for this phenomenon.
3. In brief, it is advisable that we take effective measures to resolve this problem.
4. For all the advantages of short messages, they are by no means without any limitations.
5. Idol worship has generated negative effects on the growth of teenagers.

6. The government is supposed to take legislative measures to protect the environment.

4. 历年真题

10 年



参考范文

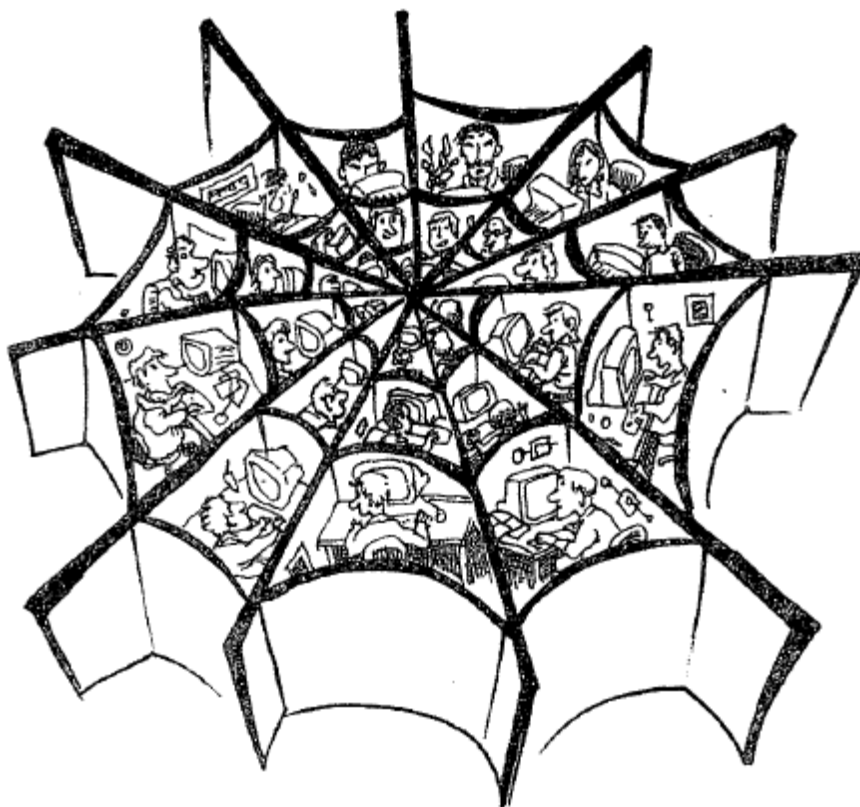
As is vividly depicted in the drawing, in the middle of the cartoon stands a hot pot, containing many Chinese cultural symbols, such as Beijing operas, Daoism, and some foreign cultural symbols, etc. How impressive the drawing is in describing the common phenomenon that Chinese culture is becoming increasingly integrated into the world. The drawer's intention seems to be highly self-evident and the meaning causes us to be thought-provoking.

It holds to be apparent that the cartoon is indicative of a pervasive phenomenon with regard to culture. When it comes to culture, its great impacts and benefits can't be too estimated. As China opens to the outside world, our traditional culture is embracing the foreign culture, thus making our Chinese culture more diversified, colorful and internationalized just like a melting pot. What the picture conveys goes far beyond

this. The fact that people from different countries are attracted to each other, indicating that to some extent different cultures can be accepted, respected, appreciated and shared internationally. In other words, Chinese unique culture can become international through worldwide economic and cultural exchanges. Since the trend of globalization become irresistible, cultural integration can effectively improve mutual understanding and friendship among different countries.

In my personal sense, Chinese national culture as priceless spiritual treasure should be preserved and cherished. Meanwhile, there are good reasons to embrace foreign cultures on the ground that those ideas from the other cultures can provide a different perspective for us to observe the world in the long run. However, confronted with a different culture, we should be sensible enough to absorb its essence and to resist its dark side. Only in this way can we promote cultural integration and development positively, thus making our motherland dimensional, colorful and vigorous. (303 words)

09 年



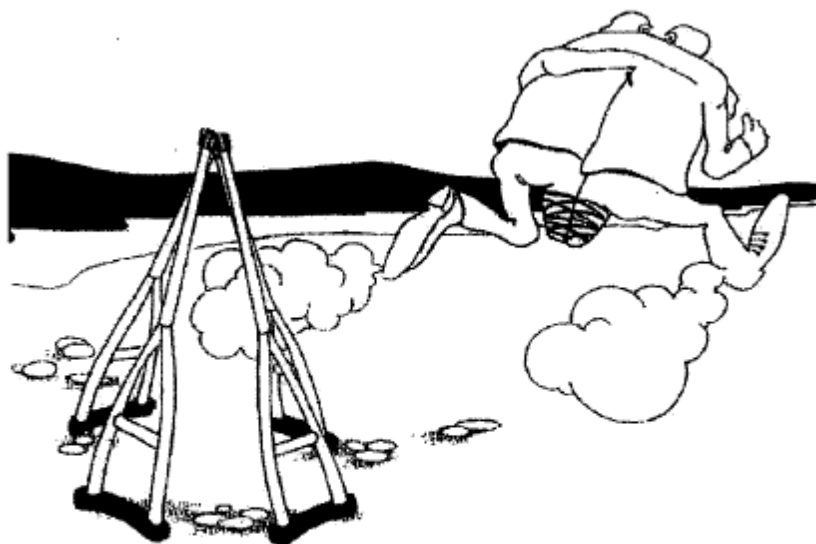
网络的“近”与“远”

Vividly depicted in the cartoon is a race of humans on a social network that are isolated in their own little cubicles. They are all sitting in front of their computers, connected to each other through the Internet and their devoted looks and postures showed their addiction to the Internet.

This cartoon, I believe, intends to draw our attentions to the negative effects the Internet has brought to our daily life as it brings in some benefits, such as easy access to information, instant communication with people from afar and cheap cost of communication. The more people are hooked to the Net, the more isolated they are from the real world. Since people can easily pretend their identities on the Internet, everything online becomes illusive and untrustworthy. The Internet, which was intended to bring people closer to each other, in effect prevents people from making real acquaintances that one can make with a casual exchange of greetings and eye-contact in a face-to-face communication.

Serious consequences, such as fear of real-time interactions, online cheating or blackmailing, may follow if the use of the Internet is not brought under systematic control. I strongly suggest that people only use the Internet for necessary business transactions and personal contacts with those they have already known face to face.

08 年



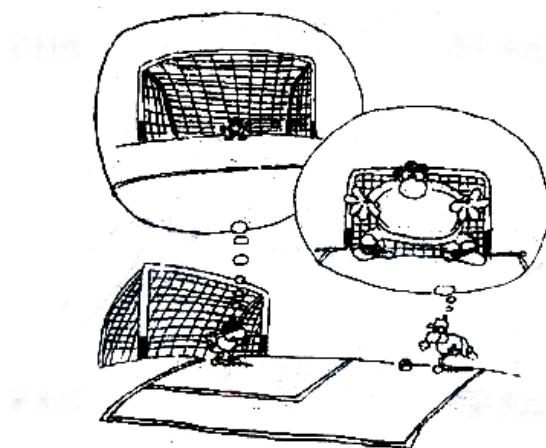
你一条腿,我一条腿;
你我一起,走南闯北。

What an astonishing picture it is above! Two one-legged men are running together on each other's help. Departed, they would have been unable to move even an inch forward, combined, they are now capable of running over any intact person.

As the core value of development strategy at the time being, sense of cooperation and its weight couldn't be more clearly proved and revealed in the picture above-shown. In real world, no one is perfect, rather we are all flawed and fallible. With limited strength and unavoidable shortage, it is hard for an individual to reach great achievement all by his own. United, however, other person's advantage will perfectly and swiftly cover our shortcomings, and a win-win policy will be expectable around the corner.

From my own perspective, such an understanding will do good to our society if it is carried out more profoundly. Only through a mutual aiding system assisted by government can Social harmony actually come true. Therefore a well-established system should be in use so that different communities, groups and families can live on one another, sharing interests and achievements. As it has been announced by UN in 2000, united, we are the world!

07 年



This is a very meaningful and thought-provoking cartoon. As is symbolically illustrated, on a football field, a striker is preparing to shoot at the goal defended by a goalkeeper, who was imagined to be a giant and cover the whole gate. Meanwhile, in the defending player's mind, he is so much smaller than he actually is that guarding the goal becomes a mission impossible.

The purpose of the picture is to reveal to us the vital importance of self-confidence. In face of seemingly insurmountable challenges or predicament, self-assuredness is of utmost significance. No matter how much success one has ever had, there are bound to be times when he will encounter problems. It is at these critical times that his self-confidence eventually plays a crucial role in determining whether he can turn failure into victory.

Actually, there are numerous examples to illustrate the importance of confidence. If you show enough confidence in a job interview, you are likely to do well and get the job applied for. Or, if you take an important examination with confidence, you will probably pass it and thus seize a good opportunity. When you play a role in a play, the self-assurance shown in your performance can help you get applause from the audience. In a word, being an assured and confident person has many benefits, in personal lives as well as in employment, and career development.

06 年



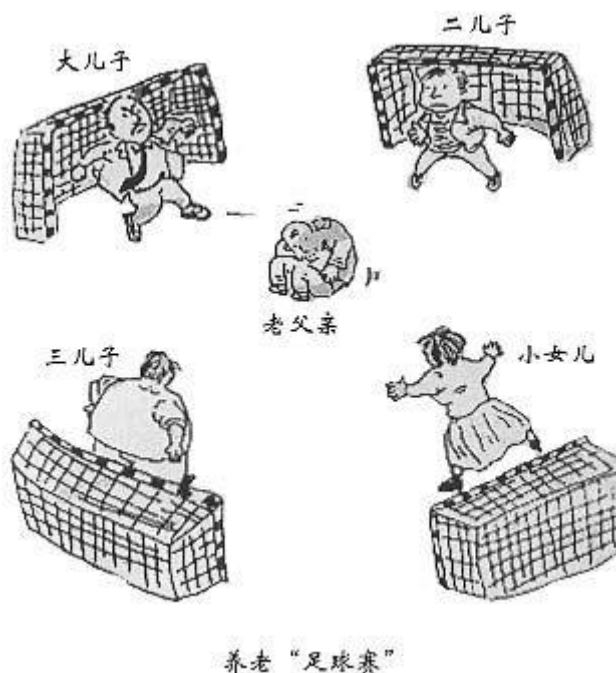
As is vividly depicted in the group of photos, young people are enthusiastic about football stars, specifically, the English football player Beckham. Some dedicated fans, like the young man in the first photo, express their worship by writing David Beckham's name on their faces, while others, like the one in the hair studio, are willing to pay 300 Yuan for the same hair style as Beckham's.

Recent years has witnessed the prevalence of this kind of star-worshipping among the Chinese people. Beckham represents the image of celebrities whose smart appearance and unparalleled football skills are excessively admired by all the sports fans. Similarly, several teenagers won their fame overnight in the 2005 Super Girl Contest in China, which provoked nationwide debates on whether it is a blessing or curse to adore these idols.

Admittedly, prestigious characters have won our favor and earned our respect by their hard work and excellent performance. Moreover, people should have their idols to admire, but in a sensible way. Evidently what we should learn from them is their

spirit, not the superficial styles of living. It is time that parents and the mass media gave proper advice to young people to form a proper outlook on the world.

05 年



As could be vividly revealed in the drawing above, four fierce “fighters”, one youngest daughter and three sons, are having a “football match” of taking care of the father, who was just ticked out by the eldest son, crouching and tumbling. Meanwhile, each goalkeeper is defending his gate for fear of taking on this heavy burden. The motif of the cartoon is really thought-provoking.

The drawing provides us with an opportunity to have a better insight into this inhumane social phenomenon: senior-citizen mistreatment. For one thing, with the aging of our society, old and helpless parents who, once spared no pains to raise their offspring, are making up an increasing percentage of Chinese population but regarded as heavy burden in some families. For another, some people shirk their duty of financially supporting their parents due to their own interest, neglecting them, abandoning them, and even mistreating them.

It is imperative for us to take effective measures. To begin with, in order to eliminate the brutal phenomenon, relevant laws and regulations should be made to

severely punish those who shun the responsibilities of caring their parents. In addition, young people are supposed to be cultivated to be aware that respecting the old has always been the traditional virtue of Chinese culture. Last but not least, it is a feasible policy that is worth adopting for social service to provide the homeless senior with shelter. Only in this way, can we live in a stable and harmonious society.

04 年



This is quite an extraordinary and meaningful picture. As is vividly illustrated in the drawing above, a runner, with painstaking effort, is making a spurt at the finishing line, which is also the point to start. At this point, he can just spare no effort to continue rushing to the next destination, without moment of rest or appreciating the past achievement.

Undoubtedly, the cartoon conveys the meaning that life is like the process of running, in which one should make constant efforts and never stop making progress. To be specific, this principle applies to individuals, who are born to such a competitive world where once a person stops making progress, he can hardly maintain his past glory and survive the pressure. In addition, the country on the whole should move forward in terms of politics, economy and culture so that we Chinese as a nation can gain sustained respect.

Illustrations to prove the view are abundant, but no better example of this idea can be thought than the cases mentioned below. The most persuasive one is deed of Liu Xiang, who keeps renewing the world record. Another example is closely related to us, the candidates. If we pass this test and fortunately admitted by a university, we shall never stop making efforts. Instead, we are confronted with the challenges of conquering the difficult graduate course, further academic study, employment and

career. In the aggregate, these examples effectively clarify the saying that “destination is another starting point.”

二、小作文

A. Letters

1. Essential Elements of an Effective Letter

a. Standard Layout of a Letter

A standard letter generally consists of the following parts: the heading (date), the salutation, the body, the complimentary close, and lastly the signature. Care should be taken to ensure that your letter is written in strict accordance with the standard layout of a typical English letter.

b. Content of a Typical English Letter

- a. Direct / immediate Opening;
- b. Elaboration of relevant details;
- c. Reinforcement of purpose.

c. Appropriateness of a letter (tone):

The tone of a good letter must be finely adjusted according to the specific occasion and addresser-addressee relationship.

Sample One:

- (1) You want to express your thanks to your former professor for his recommendations, which enabled you to be granted an interview by an auditory office, and offered a position as you desired. Write a letter to the professor, conveying your gratitude to him for the job you now enjoy. Write your letter in no less than 100 words.

Jan. 14, 2007

1. 以史为鉴

Directions:

(10 分)

Two months ago you got a job as an editor for the magazine Designs & fashions. But now you find that the world is not what you expected. You decide to quit. Write a letter to your boss, Mr. Wang, telling him your decision stating your reason(s), and making an apology.

Write your letter with no less than 100 words. Write it neatly on ANSWER SHEET2. Do not sign your own name at the end of the letter, use“Li Ming”instead. You do not need to write the address.

Jan. 14

(6 分)

Dear Mr. Wang,

I am very glad to have worked with you for the past two months, and I also appreciate it that you gave me the opportunity to work for the magazine Designs and Fashions. But I am so sorry to inform you that I have to resign. Because, by the two months' experience in tile work, I find it unfit for me to keep walking and running outside all day long. I often had some stomachaches and now need to spend some time at home for a rest.

I hope that you would forgive me for my resignation. I am sorry again.

Yours sincerely

Li Ming

(4 分)

Mr. Wang,

I am very appreciated that you gave me the job, an editor for our company, Two months pasted, I find the work is not what I expected. First of all, I am not good at design and fashions, In addition, I am not in favor of the opinion of the department.

So I decide to quit the job and make the apology to you. Thank you giving me a chance in the company.

Best wishes!

Li Ming

06 年全真题

Directions:

You want to contribute to Project Hope by offering financial aid to a child in a remote area. Write to the department concerned, asking them to help find a candidate. You should specify what kind of child you want to help and how you will carry out your plan. Write your letter in no less than 100 words. Write it neatly on ANSWER SHEET 2. Do not sign your name at the end of the letter; use "Li Ming" instead. Do not write the address.

07 年全真题

Directions: Write a letter to your university library, making suggestions for improving its service. You should write about 100 words on ANSWER SHEET 2. Do not sign your name at the end of the letter. Use "Li Ming" instead. Do not write the address.

08 年真题

Part A:

Directions: You just come back from Canada and found a music CD in your luggage that you forget to return to Bob, your landlord there. Write him a letter to

1) make an apology, and

2) suggest a solution

You should write about 100 words on ANSWER SHEET; 2. DO NOT sign your own name at the end of the letter. Use "Li Ming" instead. DO NOT write the address.

2. 各类信件

a. Letter of Complaint

Typical sentence patterns:

I'm writing to protest against...

I'm writing to express my great anger/ indignation at...

I'm writing to bring your attention to the problems I have had with your...

I hope you can address this problem soon.

I hope you will take steps to rectify this situation soon.

Sample 1: You have found many problems with the dorm management and are writing to the Dorm Management Office to

- 1) describe the problems;
- 2) state how the problems have affected your life, and
- 3) express your wish to have the problem addressed.

June 30th

Sample 2: You bought a mobile phone from a department store, but found it was broken three days later. When you returned it to the store, the assistant refused to replace or repair it. Write a letter to the customer service manager.

- 1) telling about the bad service you received
- 2) asking for a replacement of your mobile phone

March 3rd

Practice:

You bought a dress on the web and found it faulty. Write a letter to the seller in which you should

- 1) state the time and way of your purchase,
- 2) list its faults, and

3) ask for full refund.

b. Letter of Application

Typical sentence patterns:

1. In reply to your advertisement in today's (newspaper), I respectfully offer my services for the situation.
2. With reference to your advertisement in (newspaper) of May 2 for a clerk, I offer myself for the post.
3. Please consider me an applicant for the position which you advertised in (newspaper) of December 5.
4. I should like to apply for the position mentioned in your advertisement in (newspaper) of July 22.
5. Enclosed please find a resume and a photo.
6. Should you think favorably of my application, kindly grant me an interview.
7. I hope that you will be kind enough to consider my application favorably.

Sample 1: You read an advertisement in China Daily, in which a foreign company is looking for a secretary. Write a letter to the personnel department of the company telling them about your educational background, your work experience.

July 20

Dear Sir or Madam,

Sample 2: Write to a professor, including

- 1) a brief introduction to your academic background
- 2) The reasons why you wish to study under him;
- 3) Your wish to get a reply from the professor.

May 3rd

Practice:

You have read an advertisement in a newspaper stating that a local school is looking for a history teacher. You'd like to apply for the position. Write the school a letter to express your wish to fill the vacancy and state your qualifications.

You are a college graduate in Law. Write a letter to a law office to apply for a position, which should include:

- 1) the position of your application,
- 2) the reason of your interest in the job,
- 3) your related knowledge, skills and experience.

Dear Sir or Madam:

I am William Wordsworth, a graduate from the University of Beijing. I am writing to you to _____ the position you advertised in China Daily yesterday. Your advertisement says that you need a secretary. _____ the qualities you have specified for the job, I find that I myself fit in for the post.

To begin with, I have both the _____ required of a secretary. As you might have seen from my resume enclosed, I graduated from the Dept of Management, _____ in accounting and _____ in various management subjects. And while studying, I worked part time as a secretary for a company, thus having _____ the valuable experience. Not only that. Since I have been growing up in a loving environment, I have _____ an optimistic nature of myself, which has made me always willing to cooperate with others. Last but not the least, responsibility is my _____. In my dictionary there are no _____ as "difficulty" or "trouble". Such an attitude enables me to leave no stone unturned in almost doing everything.

Your decision _____ will be greatly appreciated. I am looking forward to hearing from you.

Yours sincerely,
William Wordsworth

c. Letter of Thanks

Typical Sentence Patterns:

1. We are writing to thank your for the wonderful time we had at your party last night.
2. We are writing to express my appreciation for all that you did for me during my visit in Shanghai.
3. Thank you so much for....
4. It was very kind / generous / more than kind / thoughtful of you to..... Thank you very much for....
5. I cannot tell you how much I owe you...
6. Thank you again for your generosity / hospitality / generous help...

Sample 1: You have enjoyed yourself very much at a weekend party held in your friend Betty's home. Write to her to say thanks for her hospitality and show your wish to return her kindness.

April 5

Sample 2: You have stayed with your friend's family for a month. Now you are going back home. Write a message to your friend's family to

- 1) express your gratitude,
- 2) show your appreciation of the good days you have
- 3) Say goodbye.

June 14th

d. Congratulations

Typical Sentence Patterns:

1. I am writing to express my heartiest congratulations on your recent promotion.....
2. Accept my sincere congratulations from the bottom of my heart on your...
3. I'm much delighted to hear / learn that you have passed / won.....
Congratulations! As one of your friends, I am very proud of you.
4. It is the kind of news I like to hear, because it proves once again that a hard-working man always gets ahead. Let me offer my warmest congratulations.

Sample 1: Suppose you are Li Ming and your friend Li Hua has just won the first-class science award because of the work in the field of applied chemistry. Write a letter of congratulation to her, and the letter should include the following information:

- 1) express your congratulations on the award-winning.
- 2) express your opinion that she deserves the award.
- 3) express your hope for greater success in her field.

May 20th

Sample 2: Your friend Dan has just graduated from her university and won a Master degree in Science. Write a letter to her to

- 1) congratulate her on her achievements
- 2) express your feelings and best wishes

July 1st

Practice:

Your friend Zhang Hong has been admitted to the graduate school of Cambridge University. Write her a letter, congratulating her and wishing her greater success in her study.

e. Letters of Request

Sample: You are a graduate of History. Write a letter of your college professor to request a recommendation letter to support your application for a position with a publishing company. Your letter should:

1. remind him of you and your performance,
2. remind him of the things you hope to be reflected in his letter
3. and tell him the way to mail the letter.

Jan. 12

f. Letters of Apology

Sample 1: You have received an invitation to birthday party of your friend, Dan. But you can't attend it. Write a letter to Tom to

- 1) thank him for the invitation
- 2) give reasons why you can't go.
- 3) Apologize and express your wishes.

May 21st

Sample 2: You borrowed some recent issues of U.S. business magazine from your professor a month ago, but delayed returning them. Write a letter of apology to your professor, stating your reasons for the delay and expressing your thanks.

Feb. 26th

Practice:

You have received an invitation to birthday party of your friend, Tom. But you can't attend it. Write a letter to Tom thank him for the invitation give reasons why you can't go. Apologize and express your wishes.

g. Advocating Letter

You are to write a letter to fellow students, to advocate making donation to Fu Rong, a schoolmate, who's suffering from disease. The letter involves:

- 1) describe the patient's condition;
- 2) the difficulties she's confronted with;
- 3) how to help her.

h. Letter of Enquiry

Typical Sentence Patterns:

1. I am writing to obtain the relevant information concerning the courses you offer.
2. I would be very grateful if you could send me copies of the course outline.
3. I am writing to ask if you could grant me a great favor.
4. I wonder if it is too late to enroll in the course. Could you please write and tell me if there are any places left? I certainly hope that my enrolment is still possible.
5. I would appreciate it if you would send me an application form for joining the club, and let me know the fee involved.
6. Would you please be kind enough to send me an application form and other materials necessary for my application so that I can begin the application procedure.

Sample 1: You are preparing for taking the entrance test for MA in economics. Write a letter to the dean of the Economics School of a famous university to enquire about:

- 1) the subjects to be tested
- 2) the number of students for enrollment, and
- 3) any guiding or training courses.

Feb. 23rd

Dear Sir or Madam,

Sample 2: You are going to visit the National Library in Beijing next month and borrow some books. Write to the librarian to

- 1) introduce yourself and your purpose
- 2) explain the kind of books you want
- 3) ask for necessary information about the library

Jan. 17

B. Announcement

Write an announcement indicting that there will be a lecture to be given by Mr. Robert Jones, a professor of History from New YorkUniversity. The announcement should include:

- 1) a brief introduction of the professor
- 2) the subject, place and time of the lecture
- 3) and the intended audience

ANNOUNCEMENT